

Energy consumption AI vs. social media

Posted by u/GhostKatoX • 0 points • 4 comments

The use of chatGPT, Gemini etc. gets criticized a lot because of its energy consumption.

but what about social media like Snapchat? Have you ever seen teens use it? Taking pictures of the floor to text someone.

Millions of useless pictures. every. single. day.

how about the energy consumption of that, compared to AI (which has at least *some* kind of value, if it answers a question)?

Comments

u/CinderrUwU • 1 points • 2026-01-21 20:53 UTC

Both use energy consumption alot. But... sending an image uses FAR less than what it takes to analyse millions of words and phrases and images on the internet to respond to what is just a google search.

u/SnooPets5564 • 1 points • 2026-01-21 20:52 UTC

AI requires using GPUs to train and run it. GPUs take a lot more power than reading/writing to a disk and sending it over a network (at least when measured by user).

u/rhomboidus • 1 points • 2026-01-21 20:52 UTC

I would argue that teens texting each other pictures of the floor has a greater social utility than asking ChatGPT a question you could Google *faster* and actually get a correct answer.

People's issue with AI resource use is less about how much (even though it's a lot) and more about the pointlessness of it all. It's just burning huge piles of money and coal to keep the CSAM-Generating-Plagiarism-Machine running.

u/Pastadseven • 1 points • 2026-01-21 20:52 UTC

Two things can be bad at once, y'know.